STUDY AID · MATTHEW 26:47-75 · EPISODE 53 (#56 OF 58 IN THE PLAYLIST)

Arrested *and Denied*

He did not open His mouth

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 26:47-75 in the LSB | 33:34 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: The Hidden Meaning Behind Jesus' Silence. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 26:47-75. Judas arrives with a large crowd from the chief priests and elders and kisses Jesus: 'Greetings, Rabbi!' One of the disciples cuts off the ear of the high priest's slave; Jesus tells him to put his sword away, says He could appeal for more than twelve legions of angels, and that the Scriptures must be fulfilled. The disciples flee. Before Caiaphas, false witnesses fail until two speak of destroying the sanctuary. Jesus keeps silent until put under oath, then speaks of the Son of Man at the right hand of Power. He is condemned for blasphemy, spat on and struck. In the courtyard Peter denies Him three times, the rooster crows, and Peter weeps bitterly.
- The arresting party likely included temple police and Roman soldiers (John 18:3, 12); John names the swordsman as Peter and the slave as Malchus (John 18:10), and Luke records the healing (Luke 22:51). 'Robber' (lēstēs) can mean rebel. The council named is the chief priests, scribes and elders, not the Pharisees: the video reads this as a plot led by a corrupt priestly circle, meeting at night in a house.
- Two witnesses were needed (Deuteronomy 17:6; 19:15). Jesus' silence fulfills Isaiah 53:7. 'Christ' and 'Son of God' go together (2 Samuel 7:14; Psalm 2:7), and Jesus joins Daniel 7:13-14 with Psalm 110:1. Blasphemy carried death (Leviticus 24:16). Peter's denial means disowning, and it may have happened while Jesus was confessing inside.

> *"Because suffering is appointed by God, we must not rush to end it without allowing its purpose to be fulfilled.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"Jesus knows the scripture so well that he fulfills it in the face of false accusations.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

- Connections: the kiss and the friend (Proverbs 27:6; Psalm 55:12-13; 41:9); Jesus' word about the sword and Jeremiah 15:2; the spitting and striking (Isaiah 50:6-7).
- The lesson: Jesus prayed before His suffering, but once it began He did not ask to end it. Because suffering is appointed by God, we must not rush to end it without allowing its purpose to be fulfilled.

Read it again and again

Read the same passage each day for five days; the video's insight about Jesus not praying at His arrest came only after several readings.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB. This is Episode 53 of the Matthew study (playlist item 56).

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 26:47-75 and turns to Luke 22, John 9, 10 and 18, Matthew 27, Proverbs 27, Psalms 2, 41, 55 and 110, Jeremiah 15, Deuteronomy 17 and 19, Isaiah 50 and 53, Daniel 7 and Leviticus 24. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 26:47-75
Read in full: the arrest, the trial and Peter's denial.

Mark 14:43-72
Mark's account.

Luke 22:47-71
Luke's account, with the healing and the Lord's look.

John 18:1-27
John's account: Malchus and Peter.

Matthew 27:19
Pilate's wife's dream.

Proverbs 27:6
Faithful are the wounds of a friend.

Psalm 55:12-14
My close companion.

Psalm 41:9
Who ate my bread.

Jeremiah 15:2
Those destined for the sword, to the sword.

Deuteronomy 17:6
Two or three witnesses.

Deuteronomy 19:15

Isaiah 53:7

The same principle.

He did not open His mouth.

Isaiah 50:6-7
I did not hide My face from spitting.

Psalm 2:7
You are My Son.

Daniel 7:13-14
One like a Son of Man.

Psalm 110:1
Sit at My right hand.

Leviticus 24:16
The penalty for blasphemy.

John 10:30-33
You, being a man, make Yourself God.

John 9:1-3
That the works of God might be manifested.

Key verses in the LSB

"Or do you think that I cannot appeal to My Father, and He will at once put at My disposal more than twelve legions of angels?"
Matthew 26:53 (LSB)

"He was oppressed and He was afflicted, / Yet He did not open His mouth; / Like a lamb that is led to slaughter, / And like a sheep that is silent before its shearers, / So He did not open His mouth."
Isaiah 53:7 (LSB)

"And the Lord turned and looked at Peter."
Luke 22:61 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The arrest

A kiss, a sword and twelve legions.

MATTHEW 26:47-50; PROVERBS 27:6

Betrayed with a kiss

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 26:49-50
"And immediately Judas went to Jesus and said, "Greetings, Rabbi!" and kissed Him. And Jesus said to him, "Friend, do what you have come for." Then they came and laid hands on Jesus and seized Him."

PROVERBS · PROVERBS 27:6
"Faithful are the wounds of a friend, / But deceitful are the kisses of an enemy."

FROM THE VIDEO The crowd wanted Jesus alone; in a dark grove it would be hard to tell Him from His students, so Judas offers a sign of respect and friendship. Jesus asks, 'Judas, are you betraying the Son of Man with a kiss?' (Luke 22:48). Luke 22:48

FROM THE VIDEO David's lament fits: 'it is you, a man my equal, / My close companion and my familiar friend' (Psalm 55:13), along with Psalm 41:9. Psalm 55:13 Psalm 41:9

FROM THE VIDEO The party probably included the chief priests and elders (Luke 22:52), temple police and Roman soldiers (John 18:3, 12). Pilate may have known from the start, which could explain his wife's dream (27:19). Luke 22:52 John 18:3 Matthew 27:19

◆ Factbook: Judas Iscariot ◆ Factbook: Rabbi ◆ Factbook: Book of Proverbs ◆ Factbook: David



MATTHEW 26:51-56

Put your sword back

JOHN · JOHN 18:10

“Simon Peter then, having a sword, drew it and struck the high priest’s slave, and cut off his right ear; and the slave’s name was Malchus.”

LUKE · LUKE 22:51

“But Jesus answered and said, “Stop! No more of this.” And He touched his ear and healed him.”

FROM THE VIDEO Peter's violence should have got him arrested with Jesus; perhaps the public rebuke kept him safe. 'All those who take up the sword shall perish by the sword' recalls Jeremiah 15:2. Jeremiah 15:2

FROM THE VIDEO 'Robber' (lēstēs) can also mean rebel: they come as if against an armed rebellion, though He sat in the temple every day. The question has a note of sarcasm.

FROM THE VIDEO 'The Scriptures of the prophets' are not named; they point to the suffering servant (Psalm 22; Isaiah 50:6; 52:13-53:12; Daniel 9:26; Zechariah 12:10; Micah 5:1). Isaiah 52:13-53:12 Daniel 9:26 Zechariah 12:10 Micah 5:1

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Factbook: Angel ◆ Factbook: Jeremiah (prophet) ◆ Factbook: Servant of the Lord



Judas went to Jesus and said, 'Greetings, Rabbi!' and kissed Him

Giotto, The Kiss of Judas, c. 1305. Scrovegni Chapel, Padua, via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"Jesus prayed to the Father to alleviate his suffering before it took place, but once it started, he never asked to alleviate it again.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The trial

Two witnesses, silence, and the Son of Man.

MATTHEW 26:57-61; DEUTERONOMY 17:6

Two witnesses

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 26:59-60

"Now the chief priests and the whole Sanhedrin kept trying to obtain false testimony against Jesus, so that they might put Him to death. And they did not find any, even though many false witnesses came forward. But later on two came forward,"

MOSES · DEUTERONOMY 17:6

"On the mouth of two witnesses or three witnesses, he who is to die shall be put to death; he shall not be put to death on the mouth of one witness."

FROM THE VIDEO The council named is Caiaphas, the chief priests, scribes and elders, not the Pharisees. The video reads this as a plot led by a corrupt priestly circle tied to the temple trade and to Rome, which acted within a week of Jesus confronting them.

FROM THE VIDEO Many believe the full Sanhedrin did not sit: it was night, not day, and in a house, not the temple. The Mishnah says of capital cases: 'the court judges during the daytime, and concludes the deliberations and issues the ruling only in the daytime' (Mishnah Sanhedrin 4:1).

◆ Factbook: Sanhedrin ◆ Factbook: Sadducees ◆ Factbook: Pharisees ◆ Factbook: Elder ◆ Factbook: Scribe ◆ Factbook: Mishnah

MATTHEW 26:62-63; ISAIAH 53:7

Jesus kept silent

🤐 MATTHEW 26:62-63 (LSB)

LIKE A LAMB

"And the high priest stood up and said to Him, "Do You not answer? What are these men testifying against You?" But Jesus kept silent. And the high priest said to Him, "I put You under oath by the living God, that You tell us whether You are the Christ, the Son of God.""

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus does not defend Himself against the misleading charge. He fulfills Isaiah 53:7, where the servant 'did not open His mouth.' Anyone else would defend their character; He let the Scripture guide His actions. Isaiah 53:7

FROM THE VIDEO He speaks only when asked whether He is the Messiah. The video leaves you a question: why silence on the one issue and not the other?

◆ Factbook: Messiah ◆ Factbook: God the Son

MATTHEW 26:64-66; DANIEL 7:13; PSALM 110:1

At the right hand of Power

DANIEL · DANIEL 7:13

""I kept looking in the night visions, / And behold, with the clouds of heaven / One like a Son of Man was coming, / And He came up to the Ancient of Days / And came near before Him."

DAVID · PSALM 110:1

"Yahweh says to my Lord: / "Sit at My right hand / Until I put Your enemies as a footstool for Your feet.""

FROM THE VIDEO 'Christ' and 'Son of God' go together because of 2 Samuel 7:14, Psalm 2:7 and Psalm 89:26-27: 'You are My Son, / Today I have begotten You.' 2 Samuel 7:14 Psalm 2:7 Psalm 89:26-27

FROM THE VIDEO Blasphemy carried death (Leviticus 24:16). The Mishnah says the blasphemer 'is not liable unless he utters the name of God' (Mishnah Sanhedrin 7:5), which Jesus did not do; the charge must be that He made Himself God, as in John 10:33.

Leviticus 24:16 John 10:33

◆ Factbook: Son of Man ◆ Factbook: Ancient of Days ◆ Factbook: Blasphemy ◆ Factbook: Daniel (the prophet)

> *"Jesus knows the scripture so well that he fulfills it in the face of false accusations.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The denial

Peter in the courtyard, and the spitting.

MATTHEW 26:69-75; LUKE 22:61

Peter disowns Him

MATTHEW 26:74-75 (LSB)

THREE TIMES

“Then he began to curse and swear, “I do not know the man!” And immediately a rooster crowed. And Peter remembered the word which Jesus had said, “Before a rooster crows, you will deny Me three times.” And he went out and cried bitterly.”

FROM THE VIDEO The word for deny also means disown. While Jesus affirms His identity inside and is condemned, Peter in the courtyard calls a curse on himself to disown Him. Then 'the Lord turned and looked at Peter' (Luke 22:61). Luke 22:61

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Factbook: Galilee ◆ Factbook: Nazareth

MATTHEW 26:67-68; ISAIAH 50:6-7

I did not hide My face

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 26:67-68

“Then they spat in His face and beat Him with their fists; and others slapped Him, and said, “Prophesy to us, O Christ; who is the one who hit You?””

ISAIAH · ISAIAH 50:6-7

“I gave My back to those who strike Me, / And My cheeks to those who pluck out the beard; / I did not hide My face from dishonor and spitting. / Even now Lord Yahweh helps Me, / Therefore, I am not dishonored; / Therefore, I have set My face like flint, / And I know that I will not be ashamed.”

FROM THE VIDEO Two kinds of people fulfill Scripture here: Caiaphas and the leaders, for their own ends, and Jesus, who fulfills it properly (5:17). Even the unnamed men who spat on Him fulfill Isaiah 50. Matthew 5:17

◆ Factbook: Isaiah



I do not know the man

Rembrandt, The Denial of Saint Peter, 1660. Rijksmuseum, Amsterdam, public domain

> *"The testimony of the Christian suffering is a shout of praise to the God of heaven.*
>
> From the video

06

Who's who in 26:47-75

What the video says, then a short background note.

Judas

VIDEO Signals with a kiss of respect and friendship.

BACKGROUND Jesus still calls him 'Friend' (26:50).

Matthew 26:48-50 · ◆ Judas Iscariot

Malchus

VIDEO The high priest's slave whose right ear Peter cuts off.

BACKGROUND Named only in John 18:10; Luke records the healing.

John 18:10 · Luke 22:51 · ◆ Malchus

Caiaphas

VIDEO The high priest who puts Jesus under oath and tears his garments.

BACKGROUND High priest c. AD 18-36, son-in-law of Annas (John 18:13).

Matthew 26:57 · Matthew 26:65 · John 18:13

Peter

VIDEO Draws the sword, follows at a distance, disowns Jesus three times.

BACKGROUND Restored later by the sea (John 21:15-17).

Matthew 26:69-75 · John 21:15-17

◆ Caiaphas

◆ Peter (Simon Peter)

Pilate's wife

VIDEO Her dream may suggest Pilate knew of the arrest that night.

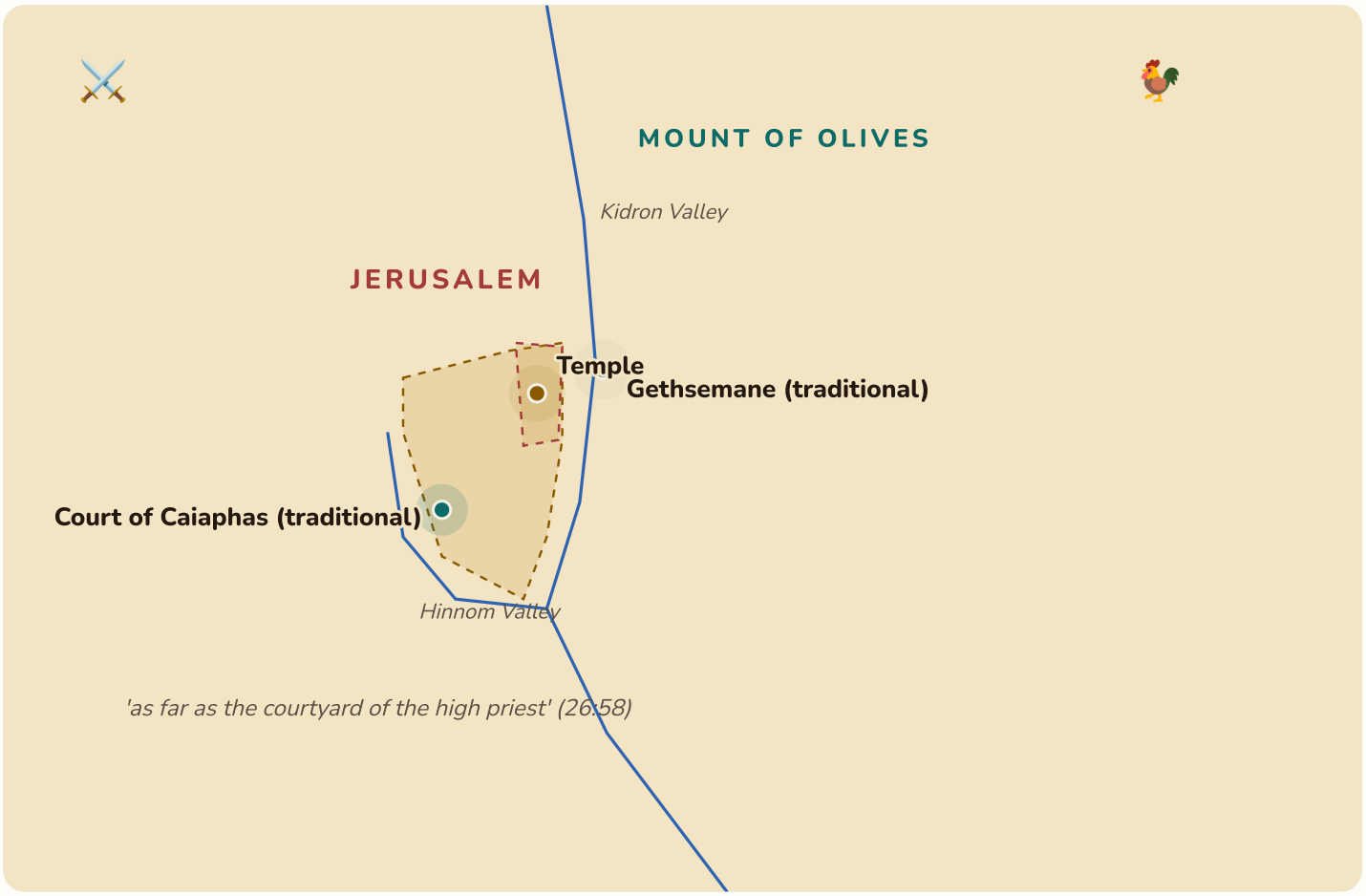
BACKGROUND Named only in later tradition.

Matthew 27:19 ◆ Pontius Pilate

07 · BACKGROUND

From the garden to the high priest's house

The pin outlined in the video's color is a place the video points to. Gold pins are background.



● Named in the video ● Background

Schematic: drawn for this study from known sites. Walls (gold dashes) and the temple platform (coral dashes) are approximate for the first century. Traditional sites are marked as traditional.

Gethsemane (traditional) VIDEO

Where Judas came with the crowd (26:47).

Temple BACKGROUND

'Every day I used to sit in the temple teaching' (26:55).

◆ Factbook: Gethsemane

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

Court of Caiaphas (traditional) VIDEO

They 'led Him away to Caiaphas, the high priest' (26:57).

◆ Factbook: Caiaphas

08

Key terms

Sanhedrin

VIDEO

The ruling council in Jerusalem, led by the high priest.

◆ Factbook: Sanhedrin

Legion

BACKGROUND

A Roman unit of several thousand soldiers.

Lēstēs

VIDEO

Robber, bandit; also an insurrectionist.

Blasphemy

VIDEO

Speaking against God; under Leviticus 24:16 a capital offense.

◆ Factbook: Blasphemy

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

καταφιλέω

kataphileō G2705

To kiss, often warmly or repeatedly.

Greek · Matt 26:49

λεγιών

legiōn G3003

Legion, a Roman army unit.

Greek · Matt 26:53

λῃστής

lēstēs G3027

Robber, bandit; insurrectionist. Look up: BDAG, λῃστής.

Greek · Matt 26:55

σιωπάω

siōpaō G4623

To keep silent.

Greek · Matt 26:63

βλασφημέω

blasphēmeō G987

To speak against, slander, blaspheme.

Greek · Matt 26:65

◆ Factbook: Blasphemy

ἀρνέομαι

arneomai G720

To deny, disown, refuse.

Greek · Matt 26:70

נְשִׁיקָה

neshiqah H5390

A kiss.

Hebrew · Prov 27:6

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

The high priest's house

Caiaphas held office c. AD 18-36. An ossuary inscribed 'Joseph son of Caiaphas' was found in Jerusalem in 1990. Large priestly houses had courtyards where servants and guards could gather by a fire (Luke 22:55).

Night trials

Later rabbinic rules (Mishnah Sanhedrin 4:1) required capital cases to be tried and concluded by day. Whether these rules were in force in Jesus' day is debated.

Galilean speech

'The way you talk gives you away' (26:73): Galileans had a recognizable regional accent.

SOURCED **Early witnesses**

> *And not even when reminded of his sin by Christ did he dare to weep openly, lest he should be betrayed by his tears, but he went out, and wept bitterly.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 85, on 26:75. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *Who was this one, who cut off the ear? John says that it was Peter.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 84, on 26:51. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

A formal trial or a hearing?

Some see a full night session of the Sanhedrin; others an informal hearing at Caiaphas' house, followed by a morning meeting (27:1).

Why silence, then speech?

The video leaves this as a question. Many answer that Jesus would not defend Himself against false charges but would not deny who He is.

What was the blasphemy?

The Mishnah's narrow rule required the divine name. Most think the charge was Jesus' claim to share God's throne (Daniel 7; Psalm 110).

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- Matthew does not name the Pharisees at the trial, but they join the chief priests before Pilate in 27:62.
- The Mishnah's trial rules were written down around AD 200; whether they bound the court in Jesus' day is debated.
- The link between the priests and the temple trade is a reconstruction; Matthew does not spell it out.
- Psalm 55:12-13 spans two verses in the LSB.

II · BACKGROUND

From David to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 26:47-75 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 1000 BC DEBATED

David: my familiar friend

Psalm 55:13 *Echoed: 26:49*

C. 700 BC DEBATED

Isaiah: He did not open His mouth

Isaiah 53:7 *Echoed: 26:63*

C. 550 BC DEBATED

Daniel: one like a Son of Man

Daniel 7:13 *Echoed: 26:64*

C. AD 30 DEBATED

The arrest and the night trial

Matthew 26:47-68 *This episode*

C. AD 30 DEBATED

Peter's denial
Matthew 26:69-75 *This episode*

C. AD 200
Mishnah Sanhedrin written down
Matthew 26:57

C. AD 390
Chrysostom on Peter's tears
Matthew 26:75

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

John 18:13-24
Jesus before Annas
ADDED

John 21:15-17
Peter restored
ADDED

1 Peter 2:21-23
When reviled, He did not revile
ADDED

Ecclesiastes 3:1-8
A time for everything
ADDED

Isaiah 45:7
Everything appointed by God
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1 ☐ Why do you think Jesus called Judas 'Friend'?

2 ☐ What does Jesus' rebuke of Peter's sword teach about His kingdom?

3 ☐ Why did Jesus keep silent on the false charge but answer about being the Christ?

4 ☐ How do Daniel 7 and Psalm 110 shape Jesus' answer to Caiaphas?

5 ☐ Peter disowned Jesus while Jesus confessed Himself. Where are you tempted to disown Him?

6 ☐ What suffering in your life might have a purpose you have not yet seen?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson: Jesus prayed before His suffering began, but once it started He never asked to end it, because the Father wills it. Because suffering is appointed by God, we must not rush to end it without allowing its purpose to be fulfilled (Deuteronomy 32; 1 Samuel 2; Ecclesiastes 3; Isaiah 45; John 9:3). The teacher shares that his father was paralyzed in a 2009 accident and was never healed; yet through it he, his wife and children came to faith, the ministry began, and his parents have witnessed to many. He has learned to pray not for suffering to end at once but for strength to endure it.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

read Matthew 26:47-75 once a day for five days this week, and on the last day write down one thing you noticed that you missed on the first.

> *"Because suffering is appointed by God, we must not rush to end it without allowing its purpose to be fulfilled.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ David ◆ Moses ◆ Nazareth ◆ Isaiah ◆ Pharisees ◆ Sadducees ◆ Galilee ◆ Angel ◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Jerusalem ◆ Book of Deuteronomy ◆ Book of Psalms ◆ God the Son ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Disciples ◆ Healing ◆ Jeremiah (prophet) ◆ Mishnah ◆ Oath ◆ Prayer ◆ Book of Proverbs ◆ Sanhedrin ◆ Scribe ◆ Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Blasphemy ◆ Daniel (the prophet) ◆ Legion (Roman army unit) ◆ Priest ◆ Servant of the Lord ◆ Son of Man ◆ Ancient of Days ◆ Judas Iscariot ◆ Messiah ◆ Micah (the prophet) ◆ Rabbi ◆ Annas ◆ Elder ◆ Gethsemane

◆ Mount of Olives ◆ Caiaphas ◆ Malchus ◆ Pontius Pilate ◆ Temptation

Source: the video's auto-generated YouTube captions, read in full. Scripture quotations are from the Legacy Standard Bible, copyright 2021 by The Lockman Foundation. All rights reserved. Chrysostom: Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers (public domain). Mishnah: William Davidson Edition, Sefaria (CC BY-NC). Images: Wikimedia Commons (Giotto, public domain) and the Rijksmuseum (Rembrandt, public domain). Map: drawn for this study.

Offline copy. Live page: https://shea-nelson.github.io/bible-study/bible/matthew-53/